

MUSCULAR SYSTEM

There are about **640 muscles** in your body. Your skeletal muscles are attached to your bones, allowing you to move. Some muscles are superficial (close to the surface) and others are deep.

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

As you study each of these key chosen muscles, try to palpate or physically touch them while visualizing their internal location. This will help you learn better, while improving your mind-body connection. Most of the muscles here are categorized into groups based on their actions.

Muscle fibers are arranged in parallel orientation



Skeletal muscle

There are three types of muscle tissue: cardiac, smooth, and skeletal. We will focus on skeletal muscle as it is responsible for the movement of joints in asana. This is what it looks like under a microscope.

Elbow flexors
Biceps brachii
Brachialis (deep)
Brachioradialis

Striations are visible stripes from internal structures (see p.21)

Pectorals
Pectoralis major
Pectoralis minor

Intercostal muscles

Brachialis

Abdominals
Rectus abdominis
External abdominal obliques
Internal abdominal obliques (deep, not shown)
Transversus abdominis

Hip flexors
Iliopsoas (iliacus and psoas major)
Rectus femoris (see quadriceps)
Sartorius
Adductors (see below)

Adductors
Adductor longus
Adductor brevis
Adductor magnus
Pectineus
Gracilis

Quadriceps
Rectus femoris
Vastus medialis
Vastus lateralis
Vastus intermedius (deep, not shown)

Ankle dorsiflexors
Tibialis anterior
Extensor digitorum longus
Extensor hallucis longus

SUPERFICIAL

DEEP